A family office backing the science and technology that push humanity forward.

Shikuma is the family office of Juan Benet and Molly Mackinlay. It deploys philanthropic capital into open science and fast, high-leverage research funding, and invests early in frontier technology companies, supporting ideas from first research through to products, companies, and new industries.

$10M+	75+	2
philanthropic donations	investments in frontier tech companies	mandates: philanthropy & venture

PRINCIPALS

Juan Benet is a frontier technology founder and investor. He founded Protocol Labs in 2014 (Y Combinator, Summer 2014)[1], an R&D lab for computer networks, and created IPFS, the peer-to-peer content-addressed protocol, and Filecoin, a decentralized storage network. He was named to Fortune's 40 Under 40 in 2018[2] and is an active angel investor in frontier technology.

Molly Mackinlay is Head of R&D at Protocol Labs and CEO of FilOz, where she leads development of Filecoin Onchain Cloud.

PHILANTHROPY

Shikuma's giving focuses on accelerating scientific progress: fast, flexible funding for researchers, open infrastructure for science, and the institutions that make new fields possible.

- **Impetus Grants** — Juan Benet and Molly Mackinlay are both publicly listed patrons[3] of Impetus Grants, which gives scientists fast grants for longevity research that would otherwise go unfunded. The program reports $34M deployed across 146 projects, decisions within three weeks, and 250+ resulting papers and preprints.[3]
- **Open science** — support for open, verifiable research infrastructure and the public goods that new scientific fields depend on.
- **Additional causes** across science and technology for the public good.

INVESTMENTS

Shikuma has made 75+ investments in frontier technology companies. It invests early, alongside founders working on hard technical problems, and acts as a long-term partner as research becomes product and companies scale.

CONTACT

James Tunningley
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1. Y Combinator company directory, Protocol Labs — ycombinator.com/companies/681
2. Fortune, The Ledger 40 Under 40 (2018) — fortune.com/the-ledger-40-under-40/2018/juan-benet
3. Impetus Grants, "Made possible by our patrons" — impetusgrants.org